ZACH TROCINSKI

CLOUD PLATFORM AND SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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Microsoft Learn Transcript
Credly Badges
Georgetown, TX

PROFILE

Cloud Platform and Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing, building, and shipping production-grade infrastructure-as-code modules, developer tooling, and distributed cloud systems at scale. Creator and maintainer of 14 Azure Verified Modules with hundreds of thousands of deployments across tens of thousands of customers. Deep expertise in open-source software development (Bicep, Terraform, PowerShell), CI/CD pipeline engineering, and enterprise cloud architecture. Proven technical lead driving complex software delivery, reliability engineering, and developer enablement across Microsoft's engineering and customer teams.

HIGHLIGHTS

Azure Landing Zones – Bicep Lead

- Served as ALZ-Bicep Lead, overseeing ~33k deployments across 560+ customers; delivered major features (multi-region, policy versioning, sovereign support), merged 150+ PRs, and resolved 120+ GitHub issues.
- Recognized as ALZ Lead and Cloud Adoption Framework Evangelist (3x).

Azure Verified Modules (AVM)

- Built and own 14 Azure Verified Modules for Platform Landing Zones, adopted across hundreds of thousands of deployments and tens of thousands of customers.
- Recognized as Platinum Contributor, Community Champion, and Bicep Coach for sustained open-source contributions and cross-team enablement.

APRL Technical Lead

- Led architecture, development, and ownership of the Azure Proactive Resiliency Library (APRL), stabilizing CI/CD pipelines, standardizing metadata schemas, and implementing secure PowerShell code signing.

Technical Escalation & Reliability

- Served as the primary escalation point for high-severity infrastructure and code issues, unblocking millions of dollars in customer revenue by resolving complex IaC and platform engineering challenges.
- Led Well-Architected Reliability Assessments (WARAs) and remediation engagements, driving adoption of resiliency best practices across enterprise environments.

Community & Field Enablement

- Managed the 3,800+ member ALZ-Bicep channel, presented at community calls (90–120 attendees, 2,500+ views), delivered Level-Up training sessions.
- Mentored 25+ engineers and both senior and early-career CSAs on IaC, DevOps, CAF, and WAF best practices.

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks:
PowerShell, C# / .NET, TypeScript / JavaScript, Bash / Shell

Cloud & IaC:
Microsoft Azure, Bicep, HashiCorp Terraform, ARM Templates

Platforms & DevOps:
GitHub / GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Docker / Kubernetes (AKS), Git / Open-Source Development

Architecture & Practices:
CI/CD Pipeline Design, Distributed Systems, Reliability Engineering, Well-Architected Framework

INTERESTS

Open-source software development and community contributions

Mentoring engineers and developer enablement

Distributed systems, developer tooling, and cloud-native architecture

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

CLOUD SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT

- Served as ALZ-Bicep Lead, overseeing ~33k deployments across 560+ customers; designed and shipped major features (multi-region support, policy versioning, sovereign cloud compatibility), merged 150+ PRs, and resolved 120+ GitHub issues.
- Led architecture and development of the Azure Proactive Resiliency Library (APRL), contributing 250+ commits across v1/v2 — stabili and implementing secure PowerShell code signing.
- Built and own 14 Azure Verified Modules for Platform Landing Zones (Bicep), adopted across hundreds of thousands of deployments Platinum Contributor, Community Champion, and Bicep Coach.
- Served as the primary escalation point for high-severity infrastructure and code issues, unblocking millions of dollars in customer revenue by resolving complex IaC and platform engineering challenges.
- Partnered with Microsoft product groups to influence platform features (RBAC deny assignments, ARM What-If operator, Deployment Stacks) through scenario-based testing and code contributions, ensuring enterprise readiness.
- Led Well-Architected Reliability Assessments (WARAs) and remediation engagements, driving adoption of resiliency patterns and earning consistently strong customer and leadership feedback.
- Drove developer community enablement; managed the 3,800+ member ALZ-Bicep channel, presented at community calls (90–120 attendees, 2,500+ views), delivered training sessions, and mentored 25+ engineers on IaC, DevOps, and software best practices.

Bicep | Azure | IaC | DevOps | Terraform | PowerShell | TypeScript | Open Source

CUSTOMER ENGINEER

Apr 2022 – Oct 2022
Austin, TX

- Subject matter expert for IaC (Bicep and Terraform), Azure IaaS/PaaS, Azure WAF – Reliability, and CI/CD with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions.
- Designed and implemented infrastructure solutions for customers, translating business requirements into scalable cloud architectures.
- Delivered reliability risk assessments, hands-on workshops, and custom engineering engagements for enterprise customers.
- Authored and shipped reusable engagement deliverables (MIPs) across multiple solution areas, accelerating customer onboarding.
- Awarded 'MSUS Learning Superhero' for leading team effort that unblocked an $8.3M Azure competitive win against AWS.
- Active member of team D&I group promoting Microsoft's mission to reduce inequalities, increase innovation, and accelerate organizational change.

Bicep | Terraform | Azure | DevOps | Reliability | GitHub Actions

RBA, Inc.

DEVOPS ENGINEER

Jun 2018 – Apr 2021

Wayzata, MN

- Led consulting engagements designing and building distributed applications and cloud-native services in Azure.
- Engineered CI/CD pipelines (Azure DevOps, TravisCI) for .NET, .NET Core, and Java applications, automating build, test, and deployment workflows.
- Architected high-availability, multi-region active-active environments with advanced release strategies (Blue-Green, canary).
- Containerized workloads with Docker and orchestrated deployments on Kubernetes (AKS, ECS); automated infrastructure provisioning with ARM and Terraform.
- Integrated static analysis (SonarQube), dynamic security scanning (OWASP ZAP), and dependency auditing (WhiteSource) into CI/CD pipelines.
- Instrumented applications with APM/observability tools (New Relic, AppDynamics, App Insights, LogicMonitor) to identify bottlenecks and drive performance improvements.
- Automated build, release, and environment provisioning workflows using PowerShell scripting.
- Mentored developers and client teams on agile practices, performance troubleshooting, and DevOps culture.
- Recognized with discretionary bonuses for consistently strong client and team feedback.

Azure | DevOps | Docker | Kubernetes | Terraform | CI/CD | .NET

SUPPORT ENGINEER

Jun 2017 – Jun 2018

Wayzata, MN

- Engineered and managed multi-region, active-active Azure environments supporting mission-critical workloads across e-commerce, financial services, agriculture, and real estate industries.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for configuration management; maintained SQL Server environments (mirroring, replication, maintenance jobs).
- Debugged complex distributed systems, tracing production issues down to application code.
- Led migration of 20+ web applications and databases from Azure IaaS to PaaS, reducing customer infrastructure costs.
- Implemented observability solutions (Stackify, New Relic, SCOM) across Azure production environments.

Azure | PowerShell | SQL Server | Monitoring

IT ANALYST

Jun 2016 – Jun 2017

Wayzata, MN

- Implemented TFS/Azure DevOps for CI/CD pipelines and upgraded internal TFS server.
- Managed SharePoint 2013–2016/Online, including 50+ site collections, migrations, workflows, and full farm upgrades.
- Automated patching, monitoring, and reporting workflows using Microsoft System Center (SCCM, SCOM, SCSM, Orchestrator).
- Supported 70+ production servers across Hyper-V clusters, colocation, and on-prem environments.
- Administered Office 365 tenant (Power BI, Dynamics CRM, O365 Admin/Security Center).
- Provided tier 1–3 technical support for 120+ employees.

SharePoint | System Center | Hyper-V | Office 365 | TFS

Medtronic

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY INTERN

Jun 2015 – Aug 2015

Plymouth, MN

- Monitored, logged, and escalated help desk tasks, ensuring proper prioritization.
- Created documentation for devices and software processes.
- Collaborated with tier III help desk, business analysts, and network engineers on projects.

IT Support | Documentation

EDUCATION

BSc Finance | Minor: Information Systems

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN - LA CROSSE

Graduated with highest honors, top 10% of class